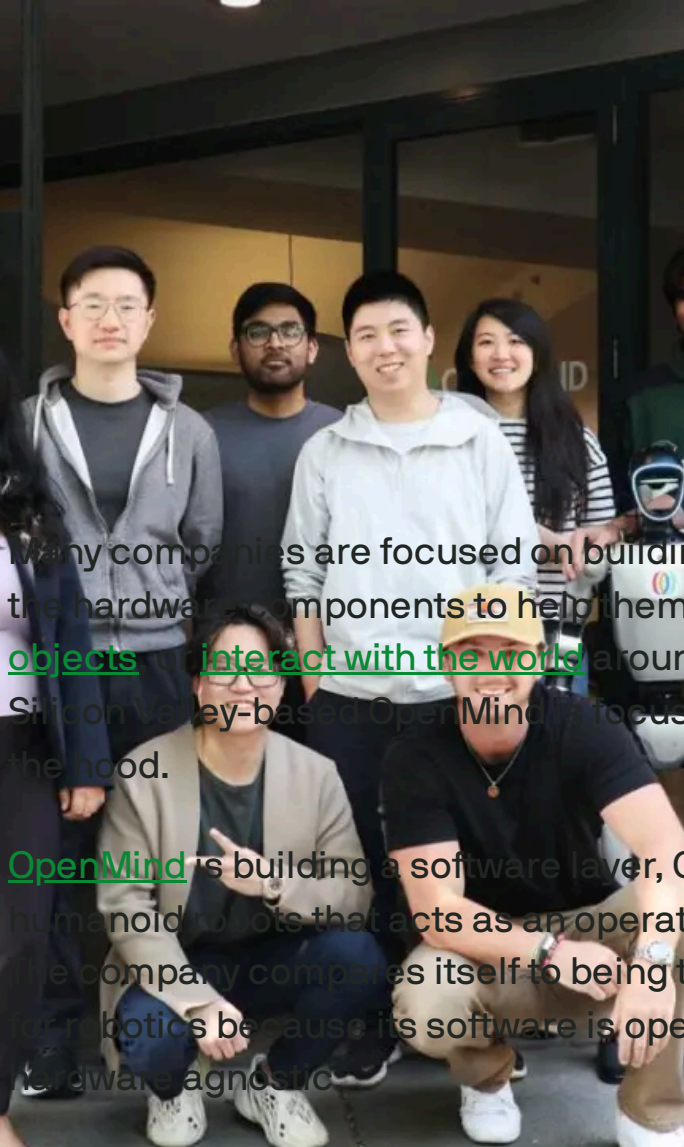


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ROBOTICS



OpenMind wants to be
the Android operating
system of humanoid
robots



Many companies are focused on building robots, or the hardware components to help them move, grip objects or interact with the world around them. Silicon Valley-based OpenMind is focused under the hood.

OpenMind is building a software layer, OM1, for humanoid robots that acts as an operating system. The company compares itself to being the Android for robotics because its software is open and hardware agnostic.

Stanford professor Jan Liphardt, the founder of OpenMind, told TechCrunch that humanoids and other robots have been around and able to do repetitive tasks for decades. But now that humanoids are being developed for use cases that require more human-to-machine interactions, like having a humanoid in your home, they need a new operating system that thinks more like a human.

“All of a sudden, this world is opening where machines are able to interact with humans in ways I’ve certainly never before seen,” Liphardt said. “We’re very much believers here that it’s not just about the humans, but we really think of ourselves as a company that is a collaboration between machines and humans.”

OpenMind unveiled on Monday a new protocol called FABRIC that allows robots to verify identity

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and share context and information with other robots.

Unlike humans, machines can learn almost instantly, Liphardt said, which means giving them a better way to connect to other robots will allow them to more easily train and absorb new information.

Liphardt gave the example of languages and how robots could connect to each other and share data on how to speak different languages, which would help them better interact with more people without having to be taught each language by a human directly.

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“Humans take it for granted that they can interact with any other human on Earth,” Liphardt said. “Humans have built a lot of infrastructure around us that allows us to trust other people, call them, text them, and interact and coordinate and do things together. Machines, of course, are going to be no different.”

OpenMind was founded in 2024 and is gearing up to ship its first fleet of 10 OM1-powered robotic dogs by September. Liphardt said that he's a big believer in getting the tech out there and iterating on it after the fact.

"We full well expect all the humans that will be hosting these quadrupeds, they'll come back with a long list of things they didn't like or they want, and then it's up to us to very, very quickly iterate and improve the machines," he said.

The company also recently raised a \$20 million funding round led by Pantera Capital, with participation from Ribbit, Coinbase Ventures, and Pebblebed, among other strategic investors and angel investors.

Now, the company is focused on getting its tech into people's homes and starting to iterate on the product.

"The most important thing for us is to get robots out there and to get feedback," Liphardt said. "Our goal as a company is to do as many of these tests as we can, so that we can very rapidly identify the most interesting opportunities where the capabilities of the robots today are optimally matched against what humans are looking for."

Topics: [AI](#) [artificial intelligence](#) [Exclusive](#)

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ROBOTICS



Hugging Face unveils two new humanoid robots

Rebecca Szkutak — 12:28 PM PDT · May 29, 2025

IMAGE CREDITS: HUGGING FACE

AI dev platform [Hugging Face](#) continued its push into robotics on Thursday with the release of two new humanoid robots.

The company announced a pair of open source robots, HopeJR and Reachy Mini. HopeJR is a full-size humanoid robot that has 66 actuated degrees of freedom, or 66 independent movements, including the ability to walk and move its arms. Reachy Mini is a desktop unit that can move its head, talk, listen, and be used to test AI apps.

Meet HopeJr, a full humanoid robot lowering the barrier to entry!

Capable of walking, manipulating many objects, open-source and costs under \$3000 🤖

Designed by [@therobotstudio](#) and [@huggingface](#)
👉 pic.twitter.com/wCwo8YPOGV

— Remi Cadene (@RemiCadene) [May 29, 2025](#)

Hugging Face doesn't have an exact timeline for shipping these robots. The company's co-founder and CEO, Clem Delangue, told TechCrunch over email that they expect to start shipping at least the first few units by the end of the year, and the waitlist is currently open.



REACHY MINI CREDIT: HUGGING FACE

open source, so anyone can assemble, rebuild, [and] understand how they work, and [that they're]

Hugging Face estimates that the HopeJR will cost around \$3,000 per unit and the Reachy Mini will cost around \$250 to \$300, depending on tariffs.

“The important aspect is that these robots are

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affordable, so that robotics doesn't get dominated by just a few big players with dangerous black-box systems," Delangue said via email.

This robot release was made possible in part by the company's acquisition of humanoid robotics startup [Pollen Robotics](#), which was announced in April, according to Delangue. He added that the Pollen team gave Hugging Face "new capabilities" required to make these bots.

Hugging Face has been making a concerted push into the robotics industry over the past few years. It launched [LeRobot](#), a collection of open AI models, datasets, and tools to build robotics systems, in 2024.



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So far in 2025, the company has released an updated version of its 3D-printed and programmable robotic arm, [the SO-101](#), which the company built in a partnership with French robotics firm The Robot Studio. It also [expanded the training data on its LeRobot platform](#), through a partnership

with AI startup Yaak, to include training data for self-driving machines.

Topics: [AI](#) [artificial intelligence](#) [Hugging Face](#)

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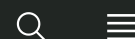
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ROBOTICS



Why Intempus thinks robots should have a human physiological state

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humans better interact with these machines and better predict their movements. Giving these robots human-like reactions will also produce data that can be used to better train AI models.

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IMAGE CREDITS:
CHIRO CHINO / GETTY IMAGES

These robots will show expression through kinetic movements, Warner told TechCrunch.

“Humans derive a lot of our subconscious signals, not from face, not from semantics, but solely from the movement of your arms and your torso,” Warner said. “This extends to dogs and cats and other animals that aren’t humans.”

Warner said he got the idea for Intempus while he was working at AI research lab [Midjourney](#). He said Midjourney, like many other AI research labs, was working on [world AI models](#), or AI models that understand and make decisions based on the dynamics of the real world and spatial properties, as opposed to just cause and effect.

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Rebecca Szkutak - 3 days ago



IMAGE CREDITS: TEDDY WARNER

But it will be really hard for these models to achieve this spatial reasoning, Warner realized, because a lot of

the data the models were being trained on came from robots that didn't have this spatial reasoning, either.

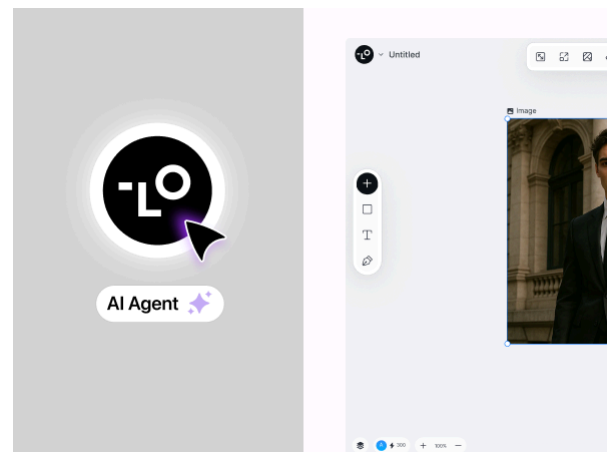
"Robots currently go from A to C, that is observation to action, whereas humans, and all living things, have this intermediary B step that we call physiological state," Warner said. "Robots don't have physiological state. They don't have fun, they don't have stress. If we want robots to understand the world like a human can, and be able to communicate with humans in a way that is innate to us, that is less uncanny, more predictable, we have to give them this B step."

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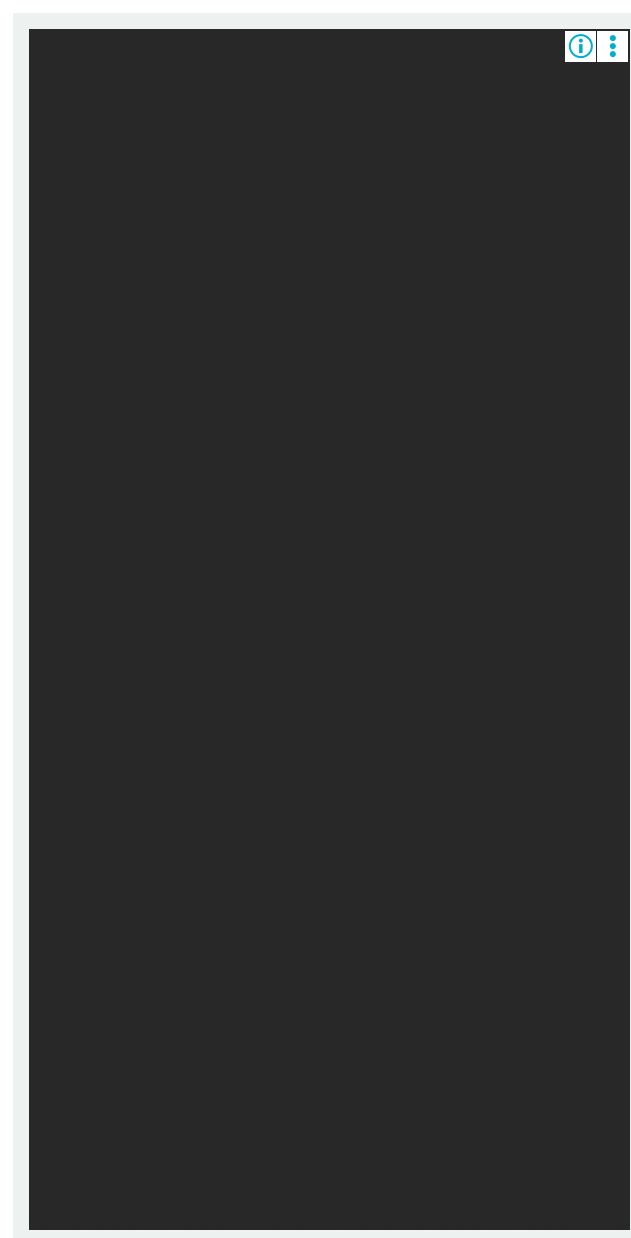
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Warner took that idea and started to research. He started with fMRI data, which measures brain activity by detecting changes in blood flow and oxygen, but it didn't work. Then his friend suggested trying a polygraph (lie detector test), which works by capturing sweat data, and he started to find some success.

"I was shocked at how quickly I could go from capturing sweat data for myself and a few of my friends and then training this model that can essentially allow robots to have an emotional composition solely based on sweat data," Warner said.

He's since expanded from sweat data into other areas, like body temperature, heart rate, and photoplethysmography, which measures the blood volume changes in the microvascular level of the skin, among others.

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Warner launched Intempus in September 2024 and spent the first four months exclusively on research. He's spent the last few on a mix of building up these emotional capabilities for robots and engaging potential customers. He's already signed seven enterprise robotics partners.

Intempus is also part of the current cohort of Peter Thiel’s [Thiel Fellowship program](#), which gives young entrepreneurs \$200,000 over two years to drop out of school and build their companies.

Warner said the next step for Intempus is to hire — he’s done everything until now as a team of one — and get some of the tech that’s already been built in front of humans to start testing. While Intempus is currently working on retrofitting existing robots and plans to focus on that, Warner said he’d never rule out Intempus building its own emotionally intelligent robots in the future.

“I have a bunch of robots, and they run a bunch of emotions, and I want to have someone come in and just understand that this robot is a joyful robot, and if I can innately convey some emotion, some intents that the robot holds, then I’ve done my job properly,” Warner said. “I think I can, you know, really prove that I’ve done this over the next four to six months.”

Topics: [AI](#) [artificial intelligence](#) [humanoid robots](#)

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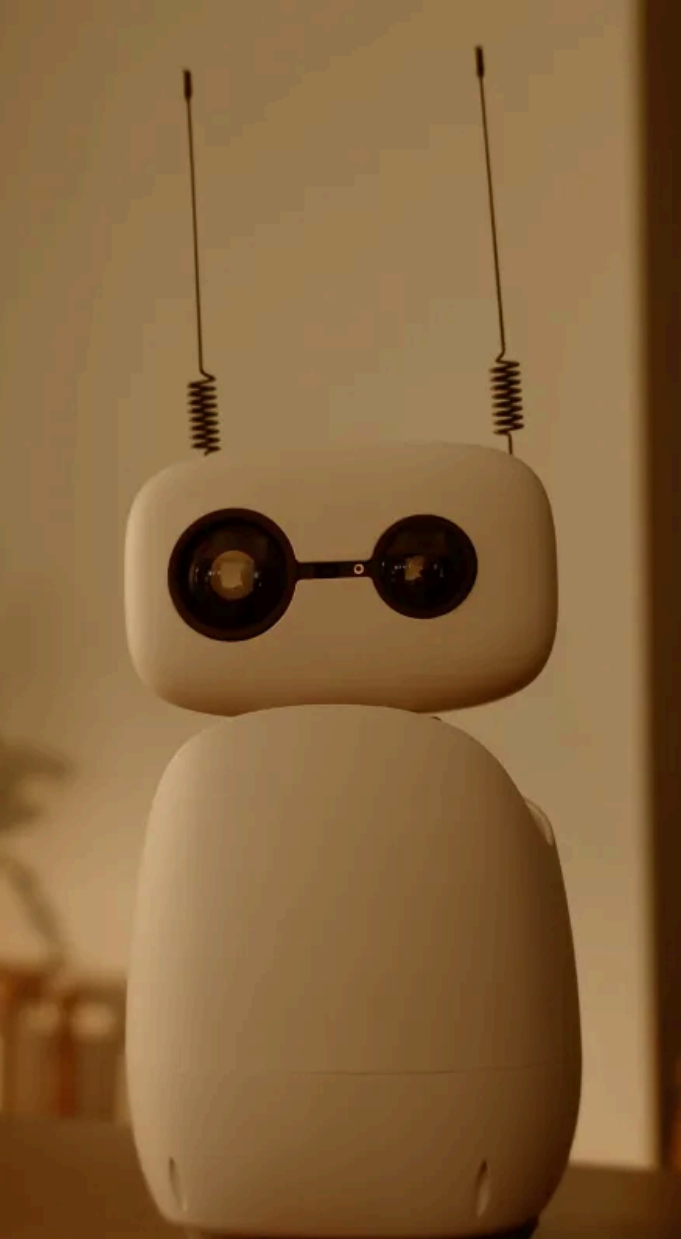


IMAGE CREDITS: HUGGING FACE

ROBOTICS



Hugging Face opens up orders for its Reachy Mini desktop robots

Rebecca Szkutak — 12:00 AM PDT · July 9, 2025

[Hugging Face](#) is ready for developers to start tinkering and testing its latest robotics release.

The AI development platform announced Wednesday that it's now accepting orders for its Reachy Mini desktop robots. The company initially [unveiled the prototypes of these devices back in May](#), alongside a larger humanoid robot named HopeJR.

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Hugging Face said it plans to release two versions of the Reachy Mini. The first, called the Reachy Mini Wireless, is wireless and costs \$449 and runs on a Raspberry 5 mini computer. The second version is the Reachy Mini Lite, which needs to be connected to a computing source but is cheaper at \$299.

The open source robots come in a kit for developers to build themselves. The Reachy Minis are about the size of a standard stuffed animal and come with two screens for eyes and two antennas.

Once built, these robots are fully programmable in Python. These devices also come with a set of pre-installed demos and are integrated with the [Hugging Face Hub](#), the company's open source machine learning platform, which gives users access to more than 1.7 million AI models and more than 400,000 datasets.

Clém Delangue, the CEO of Hugging Face, told TechCrunch they decided to launch two versions of the Reachy Mini based on initial feedback on the company's original prototype. An early tester found that their 5-year-old daughter wanted to take the desktop robot around the house with her. The company figured she wouldn't be the only one.

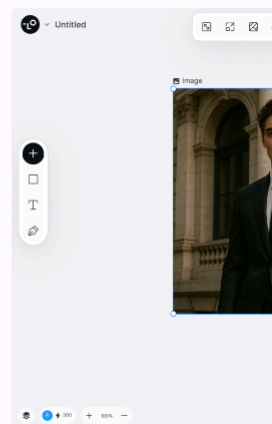
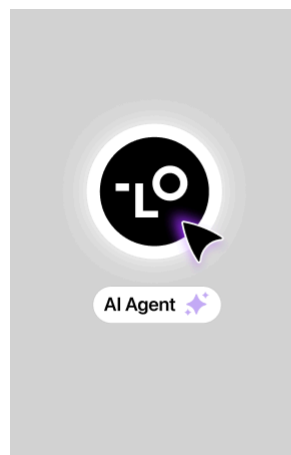
"The goal in the future is to keep carefully getting a lot of feedback like that from users, from the community; that's how we've always been building products at Hugging Face as an open source community platform," Delangue said. "By the nature of it being open source, it means that people will be able to extend it, modify it, change everything they want."

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The target audience for these devices is AI developers, Delangue said. The Reachy Minis allow users to code, build, and test AI applications on the desktop robot.

“Anyone will be able to build their own specific features and apps for Reachy Mini that then they’ll be able to share with the community,” Delangue said. “So we hope that it’s really going to unleash the creativity of builders to build, you know, millions of different applications, millions of different features that they can share with the community, so that anyone can then, like, plug and play with it.”

The Reachy Mini Lite should start shipping next month, with the wireless version shipping later this year. Delangue said it was important for the company to start shipping shortly after orders, as opposed to doing a long preorder process with an unclear timeline, because they want to get the robots in users’ hands as fast as possible.



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Delangue added this release is really in line with what Hugging Face is targeting for its robotics program in general — open source hardware that gives users complete control.

“I feel like it’s really important for the future of robotics to be open source, instead of being closed source, black box, [and] concentrated in the hands of a few companies,” Delangue said. “I think it’s quite a scary world to have like millions of robots in people’s home controlled by one company, with customers, users, not really being able to control them, understand them. I would much rather live in a place, or in a world, or in a country, where everyone can have some control over the robots.”

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